

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET

Title of Study: Perceptions and challenges for poultry producers implementing biosecurity in the UK

University of Surrey Ref: _____

PLEASE KEEP A COPY OF THIS INFORMATION SHEET FOR YOUR RECORDS

Section: Taking Part

Invitation Paragraph

We would like to invite you to participate in this research study. You should only participate if you want to; choosing not to take part will not disadvantage you in any way. Before you decide whether you want to take part, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what your participation will involve. If you have any questions, you can contact us using the contact details at the end of this information sheet.

What is the purpose of the study?

The aim and objectives of this study are to understand two things. Firstly, we would like to understand the perception of biosecurity by poultry producers working in the UK. Secondly, we would also like to understand what challenges poultry producers may be facing in implementing biosecurity on the farms that they work on.

The study will involve questions that investigate the following areas:

1. Demographic information about the farm that you work on
2. Information that helps us to understand your personal experience in poultry farming
3. Current biosecurity protocols that are currently in use on the farm that you work on
4. What your current awareness is of infectious diseases which may be a threat to production

Who is responsible for this study?

This study is the responsibility of Dr Abel Ekiri the University of Surrey and also involves collaborators based in the European Partnership in Animal Health and Welfare.

Why have I been invited to take part?

You are invited to participate in this study because you have seen the advertisement for this survey, and you work in poultry production in the UK.

Do I have to take part?

Participation is voluntary and you do not have to take part. The study is described in full here and at the beginning of the survey. If you do not wish to take part in the survey, you can simply exit the survey at any point prior to submitting the answers you have given. There is also an option to state that you do not want to take part at the beginning of the study.

Please contact us if there is anything that is not clear, or if you have any questions, or need more information. Contact information is available at the bottom of this information sheet.

What will happen to me if I decide to take part?

If you decide to take part, you will be given this information sheet to keep and will be asked to give consent at the beginning of the survey to confirm your agreement to participate. A copy of the consent form will be offered before you begin the survey, this will be provided in a downloadable format for your records.

What happens if I do not want to take part or if I change my mind?

You are free to withdraw from the study at any time, without giving a reason. To withdraw whilst completing the survey, simply exit the survey prior to submitting your answers.

If you have completed the survey and submitted your answers, it may be difficult to remove this data from the study as it will have been entered anonymously.

If you have stated at the end of the survey, you are happy for us to contact you for further correspondence we will then be able to identify your survey answers and remove them from the study. If this is the case, please see section “What happens to my data if I withdraw” for more detail.

What happens to my data if I want to withdraw?

If we can identify your survey data based on contact details provided during the survey, we will be able to remove them from the study up to 31 days (1 month) following the data collection. After this time, the information may be included in an output such as a publication or report. As such at this point, we will no longer be able to withdraw data.

What are the possible benefits in taking part?

We currently believe that there is little to no data on challenges to implementing biosecurity measures in outdoor production systems in the UK. If you take part in this survey and share your experience with us of working in poultry production, we hope to identify what the challenges are for poultry producers and develop outputs that support poultry producers into the future.

Are there any potential risks involved?

There are no risks or disadvantages to participating in this study.

How is the project being funded?

This research is being funded by the European Commission and the University of Surrey through the European Partnership in Animal Health and Welfare (EUP AH&W)

Will my participation be kept confidential?

We are responsible for making sure your participation is kept confidential, and any data is kept secure and used only in the way described in this information sheet. Your information may be reviewed for monitoring and audit purposes, by the University of Surrey and/or regulators who will treat your data in confidence.

Will my data be shared or used in future research studies?

The data you provide as an individual will not be shared, however the anonymised data from the survey will be shared with our collaborations in the European Partnership in Animal Health and Welfare (EUPAH&W). The data you have provided will be collated and analysed for patterns in perceptions on biosecurity, and challenges to implementation in biosecurity for poultry producers. This data will likely be written up in a report or publication, and the findings may be used as preliminary data for a grant application.

What will happen to the results of the study?

We will produce a final report summarising the main findings, however as stated above the data may go on to be published or used as preliminary findings for a grant application.

Who has reviewed this study?

This research has been reviewed by an independent group of people, called an Ethics Committee. This study was reviewed and given a favourable ethical opinion by the University of Surrey.

Section: Your personal data

What is personal data?

‘Personal Data’ means any information relating to an identified or identifiable individual (‘data subject’); an identifiable individual is one who can be identified, directly or indirectly from that data. We will be collecting and using some of your personal data that is relevant to completing the study.

The information that we will collect will include your name and contact details (if you agree for follow up correspondence), your age, your position on the farm and the outward code of the farm that you work on. All this information is called ‘personal data’. The personal data collected will be used to answer the questions laid out in the ‘What is the purpose of the study’ section.

Who is handling my personal data?

The University of Surrey who will act as the Controller, has the legal responsibility for processing personal data in this study. The research team will process your personal data and is responsible for looking after your information and using it in accordance with UK Data protection legislation.

As a Controller, we must only use personal data from people who have agreed to take part in research and process this data in accordance with UK Data Protection legislation. The University of Surrey processes personal data for the purposes of carrying out research in the **public interest** and special category data is processed on an additional condition necessary for **research purposes**. This means that when you agree to take part in this research study, we will process your data in the ways needed to achieve the outcomes of the study.

If you have concerns about how we have handled your personal data, you can contact our Data Protection Officer who will investigate the matter (dataprotection@surrey.ac.uk).

You can find out more about how we use your information <https://www.surrey.ac.uk/information-management/data-protection> and/or by contacting dataprotection@surrey.ac.uk.

Section: Further information

What if you have a query or something goes wrong?

If you are unsure about something you can contact the research team for further advice using the contact details at the bottom of this information sheet.

However, if your query has not been handled to your satisfaction, or if you are unhappy and wish to make a formal complaint to someone independent of the research team, then please contact:

Assurance
Research Innovation and Impact
University of Surrey
Senate House, Guildford, Surrey, GU2 7XH
Email: ethics@surrey.ac.uk

The University has in place the relevant insurance policies which apply to this study. If you wish to complain or have concerns about how you have been treated during the course of this study, then you should follow the instructions given above.

Who should I contact for further information?

If you have any questions or require more information about this study, please contact the research team using the following contact details:

Dr Abel Ekiri
Lecturer in Infectious Disease Epidemiology
Veterinary School of Medicine, University of Surrey, Guildford, GU2 7AL
ab.ekiri@surrey.ac.uk

01483 688779

Thank you for reading this information sheet and for considering taking part in this research.